

PAYTM AI HACKATHON

Hackathon Themes

One daysprint • Hyderabad • 22nd August 2026

The hackathon runs across two themes. Each theme defines a problem space, not a solution. Within a theme, participants are free to choose their own problem and approach, but every solution must be built for the existing Paytm stack. It should plug into Paytm's current products and ecosystem rather than stand alone as an unrelated idea. The two themes are described below.

THEME 1

AI for Paytm Users

Intelligent features that improve speed, trust, and experience across the Paytm ecosystem.

This theme is about the people who use Paytm every day to pay, recharge, transfer, invest, and transact. Across all of these moments, users care about the same three things: that it is fast, that it feels safe, and that it is effortless.

The problem space sits wherever AI can make one of those three better, built into the Paytm app as it exists today. That includes the speed and simplicity of everyday journeys, the trust and safety of every transaction, and the overall experience of using the app, including for first time and regional language users. The solution should work as a feature within the current Paytm user experience, not as a separate product.

THEME 2

AI for Small Businesses

AI tools that help India's millions of small and medium businesses grow, operate, and scale more efficiently.

This theme is about India's small and medium businesses: the kirana store, the chemist, the salon, the distributor, the home run brand. Most of them already accept payments through Paytm, run on thin margins and limited time, and have no dedicated technology support.

The problem space is any way AI can help these businesses grow, run their day to day operations, or scale up, built on top of Paytm's existing merchant stack. That spans understanding and reaching customers, managing money, inventory and billing, and planning ahead. The solution should extend the products a Paytm merchant already uses, rather than sit outside the Paytm ecosystem.

Participants may build on either theme, and in both cases the solution must work within the existing Paytm stack.